The Villisca Chautauqua

Best Talent, Plenty of Shade
A Week of Pleasure and Profit

JULY 21-27

Season Tickets:
Adults $2; Children $1

CORONER'S INQUEST BEGUN

(Continued From First Page)

do the chores. When Ross Moore appeared on the scene he and Mrs. Peckham tried again to enter the house, and, failing, Ross Moore produced a ring of keys and found one which fitted the lock and opened the door. They went in, and found everything in the dining room and the parlor in a normal condition, but a view of the downstairs bedroom brought them ot a sudden relaization that one of the awfullest tragiedies in the history of the human race was about to be unveiled before them. They did not go up stairs, but immediately left the house. They had seen a sight which took brave hearts to withstand, for there, cruelly murdered, their heads chopped open and the bed and walls bespattered with blood, lay the two Stillinger girls, their condition such that identification was not possible. Mrs. Peckham further testified that the two girls, Lena and Ina, had gone to the J. B. Moore home Sunday afternoon, had accompanied them to church and returned with them to stay all night. They had had no other visitors that she knew of. When she and Ross R. Moore entered the house they saw no sign of the key that had locked the door, and it certainly was not in the keyhole.

E. F. Selley

The next witness called was E. F. Selley, an employe of the J. B. Moore Implement company, who stated that he had opened the store for business as usual Monday morning. The last time he had seen Mr. Moore was on Sunday afternoon about half past three o'clock in front of the post-office. Mr. Selley was in a buggy. He stated that Mrs. Ross Moore had called him on the phone at the store about eight o'clock, and asked if Joe was at home. Mr. Selley suggested that possibly Father Moore was ill, and he called the C. C. Moore residence, but learned that nothing had been seen of J. B. Moore there. Mrs. Peckham also called him up at the store and asked him to come up and do the chores at the house, and he did, having his boy Carl milk the cow. At that time the belief was that Mr Moore had disappeared. Mr. Selley went up to the city hall and got Marshal J. H. Horton, and they met E. L. Peckham, who also was looking for the marshal. Mr. Horton entered the J. B. Moore home at once, and made a hasty tour of investigation. When he returned, he reported that some one had been killed in every bed in the house, and that Mr Moore and his entire family, together with the two young girls visiting them, had been murdered in their sleep, their heads all being crushed with an ax, the instrument of death being in the downstairs bedroom The coroner and sheriff were sent for at once, and Mr. Selley called up the John Deere company to notify them of the tragic death of their agent at Villisea. Mr. Selley stated that he made no investigation of the house, that he only entered the first two rooms and did not look at the murdered bodies upstairs at all. In answer to a question by Dr. W. A. Lomas he stated that he had handled some of the mail which came to Mr. Moore, especially in Mr. Moore's absence, that he was familiar with his business connections, that he had been in his employ nearly a year, and that he knew his relations with the store's customers ,and he knew of no serious trouble of any kind, or of any quarrel that he had ever had with any customer. Mr. Moore's business affairs were in good shape, Mr. Selley affirmed Testifying further, he stated that he had heard Mr. Moore remark once that he had relatives that didn't like him, and at this stage of the proceedings the name of Samuel Moyer was injected. Mr. Selley said, when questioned, that Sam Moyer had left his wife and family, and that J. B. Moore, who is Mrs. Moyer's brother, didn't like Moyer, and that Moyer didn't like him. Mr. Moore had remarked that he supposed Moyer would get even, but the remark was hardly thought to be intended to apply in a case so serious as this. Mr. Selley said he had seen but one stranger in the store and that was between 11 and 12 o'clock Saturday morning. Dr. Lomas asked if Mr. Moore had ever gotten any mail from Canada, and Mr Selley said he knew of none. Nor had he ever heard Mr. Moyer refer to the Moyer children. Mr. Finlayson asked if there was very much money on hands Saturday night, and Mr. Selley stated that there was a couple of $10 bills and about $1.50 in change in the safe and a check from W. L. Beavers for a buggy, which Mr. Selley had sold him that evening. Mr. Selley testified that Mr. Moore carried very little money and that he could not have had over $25 in the house under any circumstances. When the two men parted Saturday night the work for next week had been planned. In closing his testimony Mr. Selley, in reply to a question, stated most emphatically his employer had had no entangling business connections of any kind whatever, to the best of his knowledge and belief, and that of his private affairs he talked but very little.

Dr. J. C. Cooper

Dr. Cooper stated that he had been called by Marshal Horton to go down to the J. B. Moore home Monday morning, and that as they went Dr. E. C. Hough joined them. They entered the house and saw the Stillinger children in the bed down stairs, but were not able to identify them. Marshal Horton lead the way upstairs and as he passed through the bedroom at the head of the stairs, where Mr. and Mrs. Moore lay, he picked up a lamp from the floor and set it to one side so they could pass. Dr. Cooper stated that he did not stop to make a close examination of the rooms or the bodies as they lay in the rooms, but in answer to questions stated that he noticed two white dresses hanging over the foot of the bed downstairs, but did not notice the lamp there. After they went up stairs they counted the bodies, and made sure that every member of the family had been murdered. The bedding was stiff, and the blood hard and dry and other indications lead to Dr. Cooper's belief that the bodies had been dead a matter of five or six hours. The faces were not exposed, but were covered either with the bed clothing or some discarded clothing. No parts of the bodies were uncovered, except, perhaps, for that of one girl's arm downstairs. The curtains were all down, and in attempting to raise the blind over the middle window in the south room upstairs the doctor pulled it from its fastenings, and it was not replaced. The curtain in the north room upstairs was raised with difficulty. Questioned further, he stated that he noticed no odor of any kind, except that of the closed room, and he was sure no chloroform or like drug had been administered. There were no bloodstains on the bodies to speak of, and the faces had been covered after the blows had been delivered. Neither of the lamps were burning, and there was no odor from their wicks.

Mrs. Ross R. Moore

Mrs. Ross R. Moore, the next witness called, verified Mrs. Peckham's testimony, as to Mrs. Peckham calling her on the phone, and a trip she had been planning on making to Creston was postponed. Mrs. Moore stated it to be her belief that J. B. Moore had no enemies of any kind, and no entangling business alliances at all. She had not seen her brother in law and family Sunday evening. She was questioned concerning Sam Moyer, and she stated that the last heard of him he had written to his second daughter, Marie, and that Moyer was in Oregon at that time, which was before Mrs. Moyer's death. She stated that so far as she knew Moyer was not unkind to his family when in the home, and he seemed most pleasant, but that he was of a taciturn disposition. He had left his family once before the final separation—just went away and disappeared. There never was any divorce. Moyer and J. B. Moore had had no trouble. The last time Moyer went away was about three years ago, and he had on one occasion since sent his family money with which to pay his lodge dues and to pay rent. He is a carpenter by trade. He has a brother, Gum, and a sister, Cora, living near Villisca. Moyer is a roamer, it was shown by the evidence, but he seemed to have plenty of employment, and at one time had a number of big contracts in the Dakotas.

Asked concerning Roy Van Gilder, Mrs. Moore said she heard that he had mistreated his wife, the sister of Mrs. J. B. Moore, and that he had not been heard of for many years, but she does not know the man, and has never met him. Far from there being any reason to think Van Gilder did the deed, it seems that he has never met the murdered man more than a couple of times and it is doubtful if they would have known one another if they had met. Van Gilder never visited in the J. B. Moore home.

Dr. F. S. Williams

Dr F. S. Williams testified to the lack of any unusual odors in the J. B. Moore home after the tragedy, verifying the evidence of Dr. Cooper and the previous witnesses in nearly every detail. He stated that the bodies had no doubt been dead several hours at the time he saw them early Monday forenoon. He testified that there was a lamp on the floor upstairs, with a globe on, and one on the floor downstairs, with the globe off, and the top of the burner turned back. None of the windows were open, the blinds were all down, and there was a black apron over the front door leading into the parlor and a black skirt of some kind over the front door leading to the dining room. He described the position of the bodies in bed, tending to show that there had been no struggle among any of them. A couch in the parlor had some of the children's clothes on it, but did not present the appearance of having been slept on unless on Sunday afternoon. There were no signs of footprints, nor of bloodstains other than those on and around each bed.

E. H. Landers

E. H. Landers, who is staying with his mother, Mrs. M. A. Landers, just across the street from the J B. Moore home, and a block north, testified to having retired at about nine o'clock Sunday night, but slept lightly the first of the night. He heard no unusual noises, except a sound like that of one boy calling another, a kind of "hoo-hoo" sound, which, however, was repeated at regular intervals, leading him to think it might be the engine at Tyler's lake. He wasn't concerned and he soon fell asleep. He heard the sounds about 11 o'clock, he thought, not later. He testified also to a man having come to his house and asking if they had any paper that needed cleaning, and described him as a stout, robust man, with a telescope hat, a mixed brown suit, and hair streaked with gray. An associate of his was dressed in a dark colored, ill-fitting suit and carried a satchel. Saturday night Mr. Landers thought he heard some kind of movement in the grass back of his house, but concluded it was a neighbor going home.

Ross R. Moore

Mr. Moore stated that Mrs. Peckham had called him on the phone a little before half past eight o'clock Monday morning, and wanted to know what was the matter with Joe. Mr. Moore called E. F. Selley and they went down to the J. B. Moore home, where Mr. Moore entered with a key of his own. One look was sufficient to convince them that something terrible beyond description had happened and they immediately sent for Marshal Horton. Mr. Moore noticed no odors. He testified that J. B. Moore had no enemies, and no business entanglements. He knew nothing of any threats being made against his brother. He had not seen anything of Sam Moyer for something like three years. He testified that Moyer had a kind of surly disposition at times. At one time Mr. Moore wrote him a letter while Moyer was in Nebraska, asked him to come home and support his family. Mr. Moore stated he had never seen Roy Van Gilder, and knew of no family grudges he might bear. His brother had had no visitors the day previous to the tragedy.

Fen Moore

Fen Moore, another brother of the murdered man, testified that he is a tinner employed at Red Oak, where he has lived for the past three and one-half years. When he received the news of his brother's death, he hurried to Villisca in an automobile at once. He had heard of no threats having been made by any of J. B. Moore's relatives. Testifying as to Moyer's disposition, he said he was quiet and talked little; he did not know whether he was the kind of man who would brood over any injury real or fancied, or not. He thought that any man who would leave a wife and five children might do most anything, but he had heard of no trouble, and testified that Moyer had sent money home once. He stated that he was at a loss to account for the murder and had no suspicions of any kind.

J. H. Horton

Marsal J. H. Horton testified to having been called about half past eight Monday morning, and of going to the J. B. Moore home and making an examination, revealing the awful crime. He took Dr. Cooper with him, and Dr. E. C. Hough joined them on the way to the house. He substantiated the evidence given by previous witnesses, in so far as he was familiar with the facts in which he was a party.

John Lee Van Gilder

Lee Van Gilder, after being duly sworn, testified that he is at present employed by Clyde E. Means on the latter's farm. He was in town Saturday night and again on Sunday, in company with Joe Graves. He did not go home until after Walter Marsh's restaurant was closed, about 12 o'clock. He stated he had not heard from his father, Roy Van Gilder, for nine or ten years, and does not know where he is, nor does his mother know. He saw his mother every week or so when she was staying at the G O Lemley home, but sometimes he did not get to see her for as long as a month, when she is at the home of her parents, Mr. and Mrs. John Montgomery, north of town. He had seen J. B. Moore going down the street in Villisca Sunday afternoon. He had noticed no strangers in the vicinity of the livery barns, where he had been a part of the time, nor did he see any fight at one of them Saturday night.

Harry E. Moore

H. E. Moore testified to having seen his brother, J. B. Moore, two weeks previous to last Sunday. He knew of no family or business troubles which might have furnished a motive for the crime, but he thought he remembered that on one occasion J. B. Moore had remarked that he had but one enemy, and that was his brother in law. J. B. Moore had been active in helping care for his sister, Mrs. Moyer, but he did not know that any troubles had arisen from it. It was his opinion that his brother had written to Moyer, but he did not know whether he ever got any answers or not. He described Moyer as being of a kind of surly nature at times, but that he was not especially mean to his family except in leaving them. Mr. Moore could give no plausible motive for the murder, nor had he any reason to be suspicious of any person. He said he could not identify the ax used as being the property of his brother, but he had heard that E. F. Selley had said it was.

Mr. Selley will be recalled to testify as to this.

Pay your subscription NOW.

WAS MODEL BUSINESS MAN

J. B. Moore Had Been Leader In City's Activities for Thirteen Years —He and Family Highly Esteemed, as Were Also the Stillinger Girls

J. B. Moore was one of Villisca's most prominent business men and one of her most esteemed citizens. He had been a resident of this city for thirteen years and was employed in the F. F. Jones hardware store for about nine years and was a very efficient employe. About four years ago he took the management of the John Deere implement house here and he was highly esteemed by that Company. In this vocation he has been very successful by his splen did business qualities and his persevering disposition. Mr. Moore had been a member of the school board for the past four years. He and his devoted wife were very prominent in church work, both being members of long standing in the Presbyterian church. Their children, like the parents, were ever ready to take a part in Sunday school work and the evening preceding their death had taken prominent parts in the Children's Day exercises.

Josiah B. Moore was born in Hanover, Illinois, December 29, 1868, and was therefore forty-three years, five months, and eleven days old when he came to his death. He came to Iowa with his parents, Mr. and Mrs. C. C. Moore, when he was five months old and they settled on a farm seven miles southwest of Villisca, in Page county, where they lived until the family of children were grown to manhood and womanhood, when they moved to Villisca. The deceased wife, Sarah Moore, was the daughter of Mr. and Mrs John S. Montgomery, living north of Villisca. She was born in Knox county, Illinois, April 17, 1873, and was therefore 39 years, one month and twenty-three years old at the time of her death. She came to Iowa with her parents and only sister about eighteen years ago and had made Villisca her home ever since. Josiah B. Moore and Sarah Montgomery were united in marriage December 6, 1899. To them four children were born, three sons and one daughter, who met death on the same night as their parents. Herman was born September 2, 1900, and was eleven years, nine months and eight days old. Katherine was born January 27, 1902, and was ten years, four months and thirteen days old. Boyd was born on March 22, 1905, and was seven years, two months and twelve days old. Paul was born January 13, 1907, and was five years, four months and twenty-seven days old. Mr. Moore was one of a family of sixteen children, four of which died when small, the other twelve grew to manhood and womanhood. One brother, Willie, died at the age of twenty, and one sister, Mrs Anna Moyer, died November 28, 1910. The brothers and sisters surviving are: John of Summerfield, Kansas, George of Portland, Oregon, James of Villisca, Fen of Red Oak, Charlie, Ross and Harry of Villisca. Mrs. George Fisher of Villisca and Miss Minnie Moore of Omaha. The deceased man is also survived by an aged father and mother. Mrs. Sarah Moore was one of a family of two children, both girls, and is survived by her father, mother and one sister, Mrs. Mary Van Gilder. Also one nephew and one niece, Lee and Fay Van Gilder, and by her grandmother, Mrs. Mary C. Kingan, who is 85 years old and makes her home with her daughter, Mrs. Montgomery.

Had $11,000 Insurance

J. B. Moore carried $11,000 insurance in favor of his wife, and in this connection an interesting point in law is raised. If it were proven that the man was murdered first, this money would have to be paid to his wife's relatives, but if she were the first to be killed then Mr. Moore's relatives would be the beneficiaries of all insurance. The presumption, however, is that the two were slain at the same time, and in this event the money would be divided between the two estates. Mr. Moore carried $2,000 in the Modern Woodmen of America, $2,000 in the Northwestern $5,000 in the Inter-State Business Men's Association of Iowa, and $2,000 in the National Life Insurance company of Des Moines.

SEALED BIDS WANTED

To Whom it May Concern:

Bids will be received up to 5 p. m. June 19, 1912, for the installation of a complete electric ornamental street lighting system around the park and on Third avenue to the depot in Villisca, Iowa, in accordance with specifications now on file in the office of the city clerk.

Bids will be received and considered on all or any part of the work or installation.

The city council reserves the right to reject any or all bids.

46c G. B. SEXTON, City Clerk.

THE WEEKLY RECORD

Born, to Mr. and Mrs. Fred Fisher, living seven miles southwest of Villisca, Sunday night, June 3, 1912, a son.

VAN NOSTRAND MAKES TALK

There was the usual good attendance at the regular meeting of the Villisca Commercial Club last Thursday evening and considerable business of importance was transacted. A committee to organize a band for the city was appointed, and its membership is: C. J. Casey, P. D. Minick and G. L. Edwards. According to the opinion of a number of Commercial club members, Villisca has enough talent to form a band to play good music in a very short space of time, and it was urged by Dr. O. E. Phillips and others that Villisca arrange for some kind of a program for the evening of July fourth. The matter was referred to the band committee.

On motion of Dr. F. M. Kelsay a committee was appointed to investigate the methods employed by other commercial clubs to keep beggers out of town. This committee is composed of Dr. F. M. Kelsay, F. F. Jones and R. C. Allen.

C. L. Van Nostrand, president of the Iowa League of Commercial clubs was present and made a very interesting and helpful talk, and gave the club members some very wholesome advice. Mr. Van Nostrand, to use his own expression, is a "homey" sort of man that every one likes to meet, and his visits to the commercial clubs of Iowa are always acceptable. He stated that the Villisca Commercial Club could join the Iowa League upon the payment of the small sum of $7.50, and that there was more than $100 worth of advertising in joining to say nothing of other benefits. The matter was referred to the board of directors.

DR. HARVEY W. WILEY TO COME.

One of the rare treats in store for Villisca chautauqua visitors July 21 to 27, 1912, is the coming of Dr. Harvery W. Wiley, the pure food expert. Announcement of his engagement for the Villisca assembly was made by the Midland Chautauqua Circuit last Thursday through their local representative, Supt. J. M. Ireland. Dr. Wiley is one of the nation's foremost thinkers and men of affairs, and he stands without rival in the field of his chosen endeavor. He will have a message to all the people, and his coming to Villisca affords an excellent chance for southwestern Iowa citizens.

Dr. M. N. McNaughton is very ill at his home on Third avenue, and has been confined to his bed for the past week. He is suffering with chronic Bright's Disease. At one time his condition was so serious that there were grave doubts of his recovery, but yesterday he seemed to be somewhat improved. His brother, M. G. McNaughton, of Leavenworth, Kansas, is here visiting him.

CONVENTION CLOSES

The convention of the Young Women's Foreign Missionary Society and the Standard Bearers, which was held at the M. E. church in Villisca Tuesday and yesterday, closed yesterday at noon. The sessions were very interesting and developed much good. Delegates were here from Coin, Corning, Red Oak, Murray, Shenandoah, Bedford and were entertained at the homes of the Villisca members. Corning with 23 delegates was awarded the silk pennant for the largest number of delegates.

Doris Crouse of Corning, age three years, was made a light bearer, and $10 to apply in the foreign missionary work was raised to make her a life member. Dr. Agnes Edmonds' talk of Tuesday evening was very interesting. Dr. Edmonds is from Chung King, West China, and talked on "China, the Present Situation and Our Opportunities." Other numbers of the program for the two days' session were given very nearly as published in The Review last week.

INFANT DAUGHTER DIES

Lois, the infant daughter of Mr. and Mrs. S. N. Boyd, died June 3, aged 4 days. The funeral services were held at the family residence, Tuesday at 2 o'clock. A quartette rendered appropriate music. Scripture was read and a prayer and words of consolation offered by the pastor, Rev. Geo. W. Wood. A large number of friends and relatives were present at the service, manifesting their sympathy for the bereaved parents.

Those present from out of town were: Mr. and Mrs. J. T. Andrew and Mrs. Lew Nichols of Guss, Mrs. G. R. Coffin of Clarinda, J. H. Andrew, Miss Stella Andrew and Mrs. Eva Larimer of Charlton and Mrs. Jennie Fluke of Osceola.

"I take these little lambs," said he,
and lay them in my breast;
Protection they shall find in me,
In me be ever blest.
"Death may the bands of life unloose,
But can't dissolve my love;
Millions of infant souls compose
The family above."

NOTICE TO TEACHERS

Teacher's examination will be held at the high school in Red Oak June 26-27-28.

CLARA L. COWGILL,
County Superintendent.

TWO YOUNG GIRLS V

Lena and Ina Stillinger, D
of Prominent and Well-to-d
er, Meet Death at Hands
derer—Grief of Parents G

Lena and Ina Stillinger, w
also victims in the terrible
case, the news of which has
over the entire United State
the daughters of Mr. and M
eph T. Stillinger, living one
south of Villisca.

Lena Gertrude was born
1, 1900, and was eleven yea
months and nine days old at
of her death. Ina May was b
30, 1903, and was eight yea
months and ten days old Bo
born on the farm where the
until their death. They
a family of eight children,
whom are younger than the
girls. These girls were both
of the Presbyterian Sunday
and Junior society. They we
ing workers in any work fo
organizations and could be re
on. And in this work, as w
many other ways, these you
will be greatly missed

To say the community
sympathy would be expressi
feelings too mildly, they mou
loss of citizens, who helped
the town and community bett
grief of the parents and ne
tives cannot be expressed.

MANY MESSAGES OF SYM

The murder of J. B. Moore
family and that of Lena and I
inger has caused an almost
feeling of sympathy for the b
relatives and the stricken c
community. Messages of con
arrive daily, and on every ha
heard the deepest expressio
sympathy.

Over the long distance pho
he Review Governor B F.
stated Monday that it was
the most appalling crimes in t
tory of the state, and that t
would do everything in its po
apprehend the guilty party. T
city and bereaved relatives
tended his sympathy.

In his proclamation, asking
stores of the city to close
places of business during the
al yesterday, Mayor F. L. I
speaks of the appalling trage
having thrown the communit
a most profound gloom, and a
es of business were urged to
out of respect for the city's
honored and respected citizens

Dr. Byron W. Hall of Benso
braska, a former resident of V
in a letter to The Review, writ

"Having just read of the h
murder of the Stillinger girls
Mr. and Mrs. Joseph Moore
their dear children. Knowing
as I did the grief and sympath
overcame me that I can hardl
these lines but wish to exten
heart aching sympathy to the
stricken relatives and loyal
and neighbors, which, means a
lisca and community in this
tragic hour of their history."

"Byron W. H

B. C. Hullinger was o
a ranch seventeen miles from
mie, Wyoming, when he re
the news of the terrible crim
mitted in Villisca, and a messag
received from him Monday ev
expressing his regret of the l
this family and his desire to b
at this time.

Miss L. Millard of Vineland,
sylvania, formerly of Villisca,
a telegram Tuesday evening
for the facts and particula
the case.

Rev. Alvin Smidt, president
Twelth district Christian End
Societies, sent a message o
dolence and sympathy from the
vention, being held at Cresto
the recently bereaved familie
Villisca. The telegram was se
Rev. W. J. Ewing.

HOGS ALMOST DEVOUR BO

Carlton Harris, the little
years old son and also the
child of Mr. and Mrs. M. B. H
living five miles northeast of
Oak was almost devoured by a
of hogs last Saturday between
and six o'clock. The little fello
been at the barn playing with
dog and from there had gone t
creek, a short distance away
and when returning to the bar
fell down, hurting himself and
screamed, which attracted the
that were in the lot, about
ty in number, and they came ru
and gathered about him and
mother hearing his screams r
his rescue and she reached th
the fence and got hold of him
the hogs also had a hold and
had great difficulty in fighting
away. She at last got him in
arms and ran to the barn wit
hogs following close behind her
boy's right arm was broken, his
eye torn out, his head torn
and many ugly gashes over his
Carlton has not lost conscio
at any time and it is thought
he will recover. Mr. Harris
in Red Oak at the time of the
dent.